

Kamal Joshi

Staff Software Engineer | Go | AWS | Distributed Systems | AI-Assisted Engineering

Austin, TX | Austin HQ hybrid-eligible

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Staff software engineer and technical leader with 18+ years of experience leading ambiguous, complex problem spaces from design through production in SaaS platform environments. Track record of influencing architectural decisions across teams, navigating short-term delivery pressure against long-term system health, and mentoring engineers to grow in ownership and craft. I integrate AI coding assistants and LLMs proficiently into my daily workflow — with the critical judgment to verify AI-generated outputs for security, performance, and accuracy — allowing me to focus on high-impact architectural and strategic challenges while maintaining quality standards.

CORE STRENGTHS

- **Software architecture & system design:** Go, Java, Spring Boot, gRPC, REST/JSON APIs, distributed systems, service-oriented architectures, event-driven microservices, trade-off analysis
- **AWS & cloud infrastructure:** Lambda, ECS, EKS, S3, SQS/SNS, DynamoDB, Secrets Manager, Kubernetes, Docker, Terraform, CI/CD
- **Technical leadership:** ambiguous problem leadership, cross-team design influence, production ownership, incident response, stakeholder alignment
- **Mentoring & engineering culture:** code review, design discussions, team planning, knowledge-sharing forums, internal library development
- **AI-assisted development:** daily use of Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, and Codex — with critical verification discipline; pioneered team-wide AI tooling adoption
- **Full-stack breadth:** TypeScript, JavaScript, Angular; database systems (DynamoDB, SQL, OpenTSDB); secure coding practices

EXPERIENCE

Cisco

Software Engineering Technical Leader

November 2025 - May 2026 | Austin, TX

- Led design and delivery of complex, ambiguous platform problems for Cisco Secure Access, owning the **API Gateway, Authorization Service**, and **Third-Party Integrations Service** from discovery through production.
- Navigated a high-ambiguity project to **alpha delivery on schedule (Nov 2025)** with a team of three — leading the push security events capability using the CloudEvents standard, delivering high value to customers on a committed timeline.
- Resolved a critical production incident by identifying a **300k+ message DLQ backlog**, quantifying impact across **15 organizations**, and executing a full redrive within **5-10 minutes** — diagnosing across multiple levels of the stack.
- Provided system-wide design guidance by reframing API onboarding as a control-plane architecture problem, proposing a hybrid model that balanced self-service speed with auditability — **influencing the product roadmap** through technical clarity.
- Resolved a customer-scale onboarding failure by tracing **250+ appliance registration requests** through API key authentication and rate-limit behavior, driving durable architectural fixes around retry/backoff, token reuse, and service ownership.
- Led cross-service design for **Splunk** and **CloudEvents** webhook delivery formats across alerts, security events, integrations, and notifications — coordinating four teams to a shared API contract.
- Diagnosed and fixed a Jamf / Intune integration issue live during a prospective customer evaluation, **contributing directly to the customer's purchase decision**.

Senior Software Engineer

January 2021 - November 2025 | Austin, TX

- Built **auth-tools**, an internal authorization library adopted across multiple platform services — a deliberate trade-off favoring long-term maintainability and reuse over short-term speed.
- Mentored early-in-career engineers through code review, design discussions, and team planning; initiated **Tip Talk Tue**, a recurring knowledge-sharing forum on engineering productivity and security practices.
- Pioneered team-wide **GitHub Copilot** adoption ahead of broader Cisco AI initiatives; integrated Claude Code and Codex into daily workflows with a verification-first discipline — advancing the team from passive consumers to active, quality-conscious AI practitioners.
- Led **ISMAP security certification** end-to-end, coordinating cross-functional compliance requirements and meeting all deadlines.

Randstad Technologies US at Cisco

Senior Software Developer

March 2015 - January 2021 | Dublin, OH

- Designed and implemented **Go-based gRPC and JSON/HTTP APIs** for a cloud-native data ingestion platform; built OIDC/OAuth 2.0 authentication and authorization flows.
- Contributed to automatic generation of protocol buffer specs from SQL schemas, making the right trade-off between consistency and implementation speed.
- Designed a type-assisted search feature for an Active Threat Analytics dashboard, turning a complex querying workflow into a low-friction experience for security analysts.
- Reduced **100+ OWASP-reported security warnings to zero** through secure coding, browser security headers, input sanitization, and server-side validation.

Earlier Engineering Experience

Cognizant, Oracle, Collabera | December 2007 - February 2015

- Delivered backend services, workflow applications, and integrations across financial services, healthcare, insurance, and public-sector software products.
- Built a foundation in Java, REST APIs, database systems, service integrations, and maintainable engineering practices.

CERTIFICATIONS

- AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Associate
- AWS Certified Developer - Associate
- MongoDB Certified Java Developer M101J
- Google Cloud Platform Essentials

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Engineering, Information Technology
Dharmsinh Desai University